

Q Should I make up each bottle of formula fresh when our baby needs it?

Yes, in recent years the guidelines on making up and storing bottles have been revised. You should always freshly make up each bottle of formula.

It used to be common practice to make up bottles for one day and keep them in the fridge until needed. However, bacteria are still able to multiply in a refrigerator (and at room temperature this can happen very quickly), so this increases the risk of harmful bacteria reaching a baby. Each bottle should be made up fresh and any remaining milk should be discarded. If you do need to make a bottle in advance, store it in the back of the refrigerator and use it within 24 hours. Unused formula that has been left at room temperature should be thrown away.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

» **Make up bottles fresh** as and when your baby needs them.

» **Make the bottle within 30 minutes** of boiling the water. Always use fresh water.

» **Put the correct amount of water** in the bottle before adding the formula powder.



Traveling with formula Pack sanitized bottles. You can purchase travel containers with built-in dividers to keep powdered formula in premeasured quantities.

Feeding on the go

If you are away from home, there are a few options for bottle-feeding. Think about your day and how long you will be out since you don't want to get left short.

» **Take a sanitized bottle** and a carton of ready-made formula, then use this when needed. This is by far the easiest solution. You might need to bring a pair of clean scissors since opening ready-made cartons of formula isn't always that easy.

» **Put the correct amount of formula** in a clean, plastic container and pack this along with a thermos of just-boiled water and a sanitized bottle, then make up the bottle when needed, allowing the water to cool before you give the bottle to your baby.

» **If you need to make up a bottle** for someone else to give to your baby when you're not there, for example, for a babysitter or grandparent, cool it at the back of the refrigerator for an hour, then transport it in a cool bag with an ice pack and let the caregiver know it should be used within four hours.

Q Can I put my bottle-fed baby on a feeding schedule?

No, bottle-fed babies should be fed on demand just as breast-fed babies are, since your baby's small tummy means he needs to be fed more frequently at first. Although bottle-feeding can feel more structured since you make up bottles according to your baby's weight and know exactly how much milk your baby takes each day, it doesn't follow that bottle-fed babies adapt well to a schedule. Formula manufacturers suggest giving larger feedings at more spaced apart intervals, but this may not suit even your older baby, who may need smaller, more frequent feedings, especially if he spits up a lot of milk after feedings. Feedings that are too large can make your baby overly full, possibly sick, and could lead to him becoming overweight.

Q Which formula should I choose? Do I have to give my baby cow's milk formula?

Choose a formula that is appropriate for your baby's age. First infant formula is recommended from birth (and your baby can continue to enjoy it until his first birthday). First formula replicates the same ratio of 60:40 whey to casein proteins that is in breast milk, to ensure it is digestible for your baby and provides the right balance of hydration and nutrition. "Follow-up" formulas contain a greater percentage of the thicker casein protein, but they are harder for your baby to digest and are not suitable in the first six months.

Cow's milk formula is the recommended choice for your baby. It has been formulated to strict nutritional guidelines to ensure it is a

suitable food for a growing baby. Unless your doctor says otherwise, your baby should have formula derived from cow's milk in his first year. Some babies react to the proteins or the sugar lactose in cow's milk formula. In this case, your doctor can prescribe a special type of formula called "fully hydrolyzed," in which the protein is broken down and the lactose removed. Soy-based formula is rarely recommended because babies who react to proteins in cow's milk often react to proteins in soy milk too. There are also concerns that phytoestrogens in soy formula may affect the reproductive organs, and some soy products have glucose added, which could affect your baby's emerging teeth. Soy milk formula should not be given to babies under six months old, and then only if your doctor recommends it, which might be the case for vegan families, or if your baby won't drink other alternatives.